

We were taken out of Egypt 3327 years ago; it's time to get Egypt out of the Jew.

A twofold journey towards personal redemption, both spiritual and emotional

The Zohar teaches that the Matza we eat on the first night of Pesach is Food of Faith, while the Matza on the second night is Food of Healing. Many of us, who live outside the Holy Land and therefore celebrate the Seder twice, have a hard time appreciating the second round, 'We did it already!' 'Oh, not again, let's go straight to the meal' But if we take this model of the two themes for two nights and expand it to the entire 15 step Seder process, then night #2 becomes a journey of its own.

Truth: Soul and body are two sides of the same coin and ultimately each journey compliments and supplements the other. They are one journey towards our true selves – the divine mission we were sent here to accomplish.

Night 1 Food of Faith - Spiritual	Comments and jottings	Night 2 Food of Health - Emotional and Physical
<i>You are holy - You have your own journey</i> 1. How can we begin a journey of spiritual refinement if we don't acknowledge the fact that we are a holy nation with a divine mission? In Kiddush we raise our cup and say "כי בנו בחרת ואותנו קידשת" we are distinct and unique. 2. Not only as a nation: Tonight, men, women and children all make the Kiddush. Tonight we are individuals. Tonight focus on the healthy "I". I am special. I am holy. I am indispensable.	Kadesh	<i>You have to make a move</i> 1. Kadosh can also be translated as 'moved over'. For one to begin the journey of emotional and physical refinement one must make a move. Laziness and sluggishness is the antithesis of the exodus. A free man is an active and proactive one. 2. Do it with a smile! We make Kiddush on wine because L'chaim makes tonight's journey a guaranteed success.
<i>Waters of Torah</i> "Water is Torah" says the prophet. Knowledge is power in all areas, especially within Judaism where the more we know the more, the more we can own of our Judaism – taking it with us wherever we go, independent of the environment we find ourselves within.	Rechatz	<i>Sanitize the process</i> As we pluck into the journey of self-discovery and refinement let's clean our hands, to make sure that we don't get dirty in this business. Awareness can cause us to blame, feel sorry for ourselves, or be too harsh on ourselves. We can exit dirtier than how we entered. Do it cleanly.
<i>Expect a seesaw</i> You're dipping a vegetable into a dip – nobility. Oops that dip is salt water – poverty. Life is a rollercoaster where we are constantly going back and forth	Karpas	<i>Cry and Bless</i> 1. You have made the move to change and you are doing it well. It's time to begin the process of making peace with your past, as painful as it may be. Don't be afraid of tears – they are a great cure.

between purity and its nemesis. It's the plan. Don't wallow in guilt and self-doubt after the fall. Get up and move on. Add light.		2. As we dig into our life story we will learn that sometimes the 'salty' were really 'veggies' and vice versa. We thank G-d for both the veggies and salt for they were harbingers which made us who we are.
<i>Break the I</i> The human being is born narcissistic. Toddlers need to be trained to think of others. Naturally we have a big unhealthy I that leaves no room for G-d or our fellow humans. Part of the process of growing up is breaking that ego. In its place we put a heart overflowed with love and connection. <i>"Remove the heart of stone; put in a heart of flesh."</i>	Yachatatz	<i>Separate the action from you</i> All those skeletons will soon be coming out of the closet. You're embarrassed to look into the mirror 'what a ---- I was/am'. Spilt the Matzah! Separate the deed from the person. The actions do not reflect on the true you. You are a child of G-d and are perfect.
<i>A person with no past has no future</i> There is no word for 'history' in the Holy Tongue. Our past is who we are. A great way to develop a strong Jewish identity and to appreciate why we are holy is to know our-story. A guide to our own exodus is to delve into the story of Moses and Pharaoh and reflect the exodus in our own lives. It's happening today, now, to you.	Maggid	<i>Life is a story; accept your story</i> Narrative therapy is what we aim to do now. Talk about our story, who we are, what we went through, why we are who we are. The good, the bad and the grey all come into focus as we try to make sense of our story. No detail is skipped as we look back at the greatest tapestry ever made – our life.
<i>Torah is not just a story book</i> Sharing stories is great; knowing where you come from and where you are going is fantastic; doing something about it – that is the focal point of it all. ACTION! We were born to do everything else is just to enhance the 'do'. Do a mitzvah now.	Rachtza	<i>Don't keep anything lofty</i> You just went through quite an emotional process, the therapist is crying with you as well... It's time to do something concrete. Wash your hands and make a blessing - do a Mitzvah! Some people make a career of sitting by therapists and crying over their pitiful lot. Wash yourself from such a lifestyle! And go out and do something positive. Let the past not hold the tomorrow hostage.
<i>You are G-d's partner</i> Why do we say "bread from the ground" as if the bread came out as readymade bread (not wheat) from the ground? This tells us that not only the wheat which is obviously from G-d; also the bread making which seems to be a human accomplishment, can only be done with the ingenuity and energy given to us by HIM. Work is important. Just remember that ultimately it's all with His blessings.	Motzi	<i>Don't take yourself too seriously</i> Hey, yes you are special and unique and all else. But seriously, don't take yourself too seriously. All humans come from earth (or from monkeys; pick your choice) and every person that has ever lived has also returned to earth. C'mon laugh at yourself. You made a mistake? Welcome to the club! We all make mistakes and all have moments we wish would've never happened. People with healthy self-esteem laugh at themselves.

<i>Digest the faith</i> The first food we put in our mouth tonight (unless you call a veggie in saltwater ‘food’) reminds us that we must internalize and become one with our ideals. Ideals must be digested just like food digests into our system. A thief could pray to G-d to help him with his thievery, not realizing the oxymoron. He believes in G-d; but the impact on his life is zero. Tonight we work on making our Emunah real. Digested faith.	Matza	<i>Pop the bubble</i> Bread rises while matza doesn’t. Bread symbolizes ego while matza – humility. If you get offended, paranoid and hold grudges over everything, you’ve got an ego problem. If you don’t take yourself too seriously you won’t be so defensive. Because it’s not about you – it’s about the calling. And Humility helps your relationships immensely. Because there is room for others. Ego leaves no space for anything or anyone else.
<i>G-d said so</i> You want to be a person of faith? Then know this: sometimes you will do things that make no sense, or are even downright painful. Take Maror as an example. But we do it anyway because we have ‘Kabalat ol’ – we accept upon ourselves the yoke of heaven. You eat the maror regardless of your taste bud. And you even make a blessing on it...	Maror	<i>And they lived --- ever after</i> Oh no! The romance is not what it used to be! We are out of love. We were promised a more pleasant life than fighting over who will change the nappy and which way the toilet paper should roll. The quicker we accept that roses also have thorns and that struggle is the way G-d tells us ‘Grow!’ the happier and more content we will be. Obviously we ask and beseech G-d to stop all pain, but until that day when pain ceases we must use it as a step stool not as a cliff.
<i>For free you take two</i> So which one is it? Are we supposed to understand and internalize (matza) or are we dry and subservient (maror)? Both! You got to be a robot with personality! נעשה ונשמע we must do and we must understand with our unique brain-makeup and logic! Oh, and one more thing: recline. Do it all with a smile and a noble attitude. You are a king – and a king has many obligations but he does it with a smile because after all he’s a king!	Korech	<i>The sandwich generation</i> Many call us the sandwich generation. Sandwiched between our elderly parents and our ‘modern’ children. Between our iPhone and our spouse. Between virtual reality and reality. Or between a mortgage and a lifestyle. Embrace the sandwich! Don’t throw away the iPhone or the spouse... Life is about balance and we can find a healthy balance if we would only try. Embrace the multitasking!
<i>Time out with strings attached</i> Holy cow! This religion doesn’t give me a minute to breathe! Faith, yoke of heaven, black and white... Is there any break time? Yes there is. But on one condition: the break must be for the sake of refreshing yourself so that you can serve G-d even better (gotcha!). That is why we eat a nice meal now to remind ourselves that Judaism doesn’t shun a good meal and nice china; on the contrary it embraces it. For the sake of heaven of course.	Shulchan Orech	<i>What a world!</i> The rabbis taught that one of the questions a person will be asked by heavenly court after his passing is: "Did you enjoy all the fruits of the world?" Want to work on your emotional health? Then marry Mother Nature. Spend alone time with the wonderful world Hashem has created especially for us. Nature is a great healer. And a good meal with chicken soup and gefilte fish is even better!

<i>There is always room for more</i> I vote the Afikoman as the most unappreciated food of the year. After all that food and the late hour who can be in the mood of teeth breaking matza? Not me. Alas, somehow the food enters the system, and I even manage to down two more cups of wine. When it comes to Yiddishkeit there is always room for another shiur another resolution and mitzvo. You can't be too stuffed with goodness.	Tzafun	<i>Shine!</i> Yes, your teachers and parents all predicted failure for you. Every report card of yours read 'this kid has lots of potential...' And now you feel justified for making their dream a reality. Quit it! Stand up and shine! Bring out those hidden talents you always knew you have. Prove the naysayers wrong and wrong again! Tzafun means hidden. Come out of hiding and shine.
<i>Priorities, priorities, priorities</i> Now that you've become a higher person... Elijah comes to the door. What do you ask from him? Of course you can ask for everything, but what are your priorities? Are they all physical and worldly or spiritual? Now is a time to ask for the things that really count: nachas, a mentch, and a pure heart. Don't waste the opportunity on just materialistic.	Barech	<i>Be grateful</i> Thank and thank and thank some more. Don't take anything for granted. Thanks your parents (tough one) thank your teachers (even tougher) and thank anyone who helps you in any way. A grateful person is a happy person because he realizes that everything he has is a gift. Nothing is taken for granted. No expectations.
<i>Call a spade a spade</i> In Hallel we make mention of many miracles that G-d performed for us. It takes a believer to believe in miracles. An agnostic can wish-wash anything as a coincidence. The sea can split and he'll credit the weather, whilst the believer sees everything through the prism of G-d's Hand. Take note of miracles large and small. They're all around.	Hallel	<i>Be generous in compliments</i> We all love pointing out the negative in ourselves and in others but find it hard to sincerely compliment the abundant positive in all of us. Hallel means to praise and that is exactly what we should be doing constantly – praising. Find the good and magnify it. It will make you likeable – guaranteed! No one hates a sincere compliment. Mark Twain said that he could live six months off a good compliment.
<i>We're heading home</i> Why were we here tonight? Why do we do Mitzvahs at all? Because G-d desires that we build Him a home in our world. Each Mitzvah adds a brick to His Home. When all the bricks are in place the world becomes a Messianic world where G-d is revealed and the Temple is rebuilt. Next Year in Jerusalem! Amen!	Nirtza	<i>The journey never ends</i> So you think that now that you've done it twice you're off for a year? Dream on! The journey never ends. That is why some communities don't say "the seder is over"; because it's never over! Success isn't a place; it's a journey. Once you're on the journey you are already a successful human being. Angles are static. Humans travel.

There are myriads of ways to internalize the message of the Seder. I wish you and your loved ones a safe journey. Enjoy the ride.

Have a happy and Kosher Passover!

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